

choosing to reside in an affordable cost of living area so she can consistently max out her retirement investments and still travel multiple times a year. Another friend, Cindy, is prioritizing paying off her house early, which is made possible by putting a new car purchase, home upgrades, and expensive trips on the back burner.

We know it seems like a long list of priorities to fit into a short income, but you don't have to be doing the most all the time. The things that are of highest importance to you may shift and your capacity to pursue what you value will also change. Making spending decisions that reflect this knowledge is what we call embracing your season.

Embracing Your Season

An important detail in how Allison prioritized her spending was her specific season of life. She knew that the one decision she could make now that would get her more of what she loved in the future was paying off debt. She also knew that having a baby was not cheap, but that what she would spend on after giving birth is different from what she would spend on when the kids are grown. These ebbs and flows of life are what informed her on how to make the most of her current reality.

Just like Allison, what your money can do is inextricably linked to your current reality, your season of life. It's your season that defines your circumstances and dictates a good amount of your financial behaviors.

Whether single, married, divorced, with kids or without kids, a homeowner or renter, it all impacts the spending decisions you make. A married homeowner with children has different responsibilities and demands on their money from a single childless person who rents. And both need to make financial decisions in light of their season. You also may experience short and long seasons, seasons related to external circumstances, and others resulting from internal realities; there are good and welcomed seasons and there are not-so-great, unwelcomed seasons. All of it matters.

While there are times that your present circumstances may feel like a hindrance to the life you desire, we're taking the perspective that choosing to embrace, honor, and work within your season is fundamental to navigating the journey with purpose.